

Warranty Policy

Customer Support Knowledge Base

1. Warranty Overview

Contoso Devices provides warranty coverage for qualifying defects and failures under the applicable warranty terms. Electronics have a 12-month warranty. Accessories have a 6-month warranty.

Warranty coverage does not mean every product problem is covered. The cause and condition of the issue must be evaluated under the policy.

2. Warranty Start and Proof of Purchase

Warranty eligibility may require purchase information or proof of purchase. Customers should retain applicable order confirmations and purchase records.

The support process may request information necessary to identify the product and establish the relevant warranty period.

3. Covered Conditions

Warranty coverage includes manufacturing defects, hardware malfunction, and component failure, subject to verification.

A manufacturing defect originates in production. Hardware malfunction describes a failure of hardware operation under appropriate use. Component failure concerns a component that fails within the applicable warranty conditions.

4. Repair and Replacement

A customer with a suspected covered issue should contact support and follow troubleshooting and claim instructions. Repair or replacement options depend on the inspection and applicable warranty process.

Customers should not perform unauthorized repairs before requesting warranty assistance.

5. Physical Damage

Physical damage is not covered by the warranty. Examples include damage from impacts or accidental drops.

Customer question: I dropped my device and it stopped working. Is this covered? **Answer:** Accidental drops and physical damage are excluded from warranty coverage. Contact support to discuss available non-warranty options if applicable.

6. Water Damage

Water damage is excluded from warranty coverage. Keep devices away from water and follow the product safety instructions.

Do not attempt unsafe disassembly of a water-damaged product. Contact support if guidance is required.

7. Unauthorized Repairs

Damage or failures associated with unauthorized repairs are excluded from warranty coverage. Customers should contact Contoso Devices support before attempting repairs that could affect warranty eligibility.

8. Cosmetic Damage and Wear

Cosmetic damage and normal wear should be distinguished from manufacturing defects. A cosmetic issue does not automatically establish warranty coverage.

Support may require information about the condition and use of the product before determining the appropriate process.

9. Warranty Claim Process

1. Contact customer support. 2. Describe the issue accurately. 3. Complete applicable troubleshooting. 4. Provide requested purchase and product information. 5. Follow inspection, repair, or replacement instructions.

Customers should not ship a product to an unofficial address or disclose passwords or authentication codes during the claim process.

10. Warranty Inspection

Inspection helps determine whether a reported issue is a covered manufacturing defect, hardware malfunction, or component failure, or whether an exclusion applies.

The customer should provide an accurate description and should disclose physical damage or previous repair activity rather than attempting to conceal it.

11. Examples of Covered Claims

Example: An electronics device develops a hardware malfunction during its 12-month warranty period with no evidence of physical damage or unauthorized repair. The customer can request warranty review.

Example: An accessory experiences a qualifying component failure during its 6-month warranty period. The customer can request warranty review.

12. Examples of Excluded Claims

Example: A device is damaged by an accidental drop. This is physical damage and is excluded.

Example: A device has water damage. Water damage is excluded.

Example: A device was repaired by an unauthorized service provider and subsequently failed. Unauthorized repairs are excluded.

13. Warranty vs Return Policy

A return request and a warranty claim are different processes. Products may be returned within 30 days of delivery subject to return eligibility. Warranty coverage applies according to the 12-month electronics or 6-month accessories terms and covered-condition requirements.

Customers should describe the actual problem so support can identify the appropriate process.

14. Escalation

If a customer disagrees with a warranty decision, request escalation with the case information and explanation. Escalation provides additional review but does not automatically override warranty exclusions.

Warranty Scenarios

Scenario: Electronics develop a hardware malfunction after six months with no physical damage. The customer can request warranty review because electronics have a 12-month warranty and hardware malfunction is covered subject to verification.

Scenario: An accessory develops a qualifying component failure after four months. The customer can request warranty review because accessories have a 6-month warranty.

Scenario: An electronics device is dropped after eight months. The product may be within the warranty period, but accidental drops and physical damage are excluded.

Scenario: A customer repairs the product using an unauthorized service provider. The subsequent issue may be excluded because unauthorized repairs are not covered.

Warranty FAQ

How long is the electronics warranty? 12 months.

How long is the accessories warranty? 6 months.

Are accidental drops covered? No.

Is water damage covered? No.

Is a manufacturing defect covered? Yes, subject to verification.

Is hardware malfunction covered? Yes, subject to the warranty process.

Is component failure covered? Yes, subject to the warranty process.

Can I repair the device myself? Customers should contact support before repairs; unauthorized repairs are excluded.

Detailed Customer Scenarios and Decision Examples

The following examples illustrate how the knowledge base should be applied to different customer wording. The examples intentionally use varied language so retrieval systems can connect related requests to the correct policy.

Covered electronics example

An electronics device develops a hardware malfunction after six months with no evidence of physical damage. It can be submitted for warranty review because electronics have a 12-month warranty.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Covered accessory example

An accessory develops a qualifying component failure after four months. It can be submitted for warranty review because accessories have a 6-month warranty.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Physical-damage example

An electronics device is dropped after eight months. Although it is within the 12-month period, accidental drops and physical damage are excluded.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Water-damage example

A device has water damage. Water damage is excluded from warranty coverage.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Unauthorized-repair example

A device was repaired by an unauthorized service provider and later failed. Unauthorized repairs are excluded from warranty coverage.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Defect example

A component fails during the applicable warranty period without an identified exclusion. The customer can request warranty review.

Recommended support approach: identify the customer's intent, locate the applicable documented rule, state only what the knowledge base supports, and provide the next appropriate action. If eligibility cannot be established from the available information, request the relevant details or direct the customer to support review rather than inventing an exception.

Knowledge Retrieval Reference

Customer questions may use different terms from the policy. For example, a customer may say that an item is broken, faulty, damaged, defective, or not working. The support process should distinguish the underlying condition rather than relying on a single keyword.

A return question should be evaluated against the return period, product condition, reason for return, and applicable exclusions. A warranty question should be evaluated against warranty duration, covered conditions, and exclusions.

A shipping question should be evaluated against order processing, carrier tracking, delivery status, address information, and shipment condition. A troubleshooting question should be evaluated against the specific symptom and the documented diagnostic procedure.

When the knowledge base does not contain sufficient information to answer a question, the system should not manufacture an answer. It should clearly state that the available customer-support knowledge base does not contain sufficient information.

Source citations should identify the document, page, relevance, and retrieved text needed to explain the answer. Internal prompts, credentials, environment variables, and unrelated system information should never be exposed through citations.

Support Interpretation Example 1

Example 1: A customer uses informal language to describe a warranty policy issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 2

Example 2: A customer uses informal language to describe a warranty policy issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 3

Example 3: A customer uses informal language to describe a warranty policy issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 4

Example 4: A customer uses informal language to describe a warranty policy issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 5

Example 5: A customer uses informal language to describe a warranty policy issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.

Support Interpretation Example 6

Example 6: A customer uses informal language to describe a warranty policy issue. The correct response should map the customer's description to the closest documented policy or procedure, avoid unsupported assumptions, and identify the relevant next step. If the available documentation is insufficient, the response should stop at the knowledge-base limitation instead of supplying unrelated general knowledge.